QUIZ RESOURCE

# Water Safety Quiz Question Bank

30 ready-to-use questions for Kahoot, Quizlet, or any quiz platform — covering all 5 lessons of the Year 7–8 Swim & Water Safety unit. Answers, difficulty ratings, and teaching notes included.

Year 7–8 HPE | 30 questions | 5 lesson topics | Kahoot / Quizlet ready | Victorian Curriculum 2.0

| | |
|---|---|
| 30 | Total questions |
| 21 | Multiple choice |
| 6 | True / False |
| 3 | Image-based |
| 12 | Easy |
| 12 | Medium |
| 6 | Hard |

### How to use this question bank

Each question includes the correct answer, distractors, difficulty rating, and a teaching note. Use them for:

- **Start-of-lesson warm-up** — 3–5 questions to activate prior knowledge
- **End-of-lesson exit quiz** — 5 questions matching that lesson's content
- **End-of-unit revision** — all 30 questions as a full Kahoot game
- **Formative check** — use True/False questions for quick show-of-hands

## 1 Victorian Drowning Statistics — Why It Matters

Q1–Q6 · 6 questions

Q1 Easy Multiple choice

**How many people drowned fatally in Victoria in 2023–24?**

A. 32
✓ **B. 54**
C. 48
D. 67

**Answer: B — 54**
This was the highest Victorian drowning toll in over a decade. Source: LSV Drowning Report 2023–24 — lsv.com.au/research/victorian-drowning-reports/

Q2 Easy Multiple choice

**What fraction of 2023–24 Victorian drowning victims were aged 15–24?**

A. 1 in 10
B. 1 in 3
✓ **C. 1 in 5**
D. 1 in 2

**Answer: C — 1 in 5**
Young people (15–24) are significantly overrepresented in drowning statistics relative to their population size.

Q3 Easy True / False

**In 2023–24, at least some Victorian drowning deaths occurred at patrolled beaches or public pools.**

| True | False |
|---|---|

**Answer: False**
ALL 54 drowning deaths in 2023–24 occurred at unpatrolled locations. Zero deaths occurred at patrolled beaches or supervised pools — the most powerful argument for always swimming between the flags.

Q4 Medium Multiple choice

**Males are how many times more likely to drown than females in Victoria?**

A. 2 times
B. 3 times
✓ C. 4 times
D. 6 times

**Answer: C — 4 times**
The gender disparity reflects higher risk-taking behaviour, overconfidence in swimming ability, and social norms around not "backing down" from dares. This is a key discussion point in Lesson 1.

Q5 Medium Multiple choice

**How much higher were non-fatal Victorian drowning incidents in 2023–24 compared to the 10-year average?**

A. 20% above
B. 40% above
✓ C. 60% above
D. 80% above

**Answer: C — 60% above**
Non-fatal drownings are important too — each one represents a near-death experience and long-term trauma. This statistic shows the total scale of the problem is much larger than fatal figures alone suggest.

Q6 Hard Multiple choice

**Approximately what percentage of Victorian drowning deaths in 2023–24 involved people from CALD (Culturally and Linguistically Diverse) backgrounds?**

A. 10%
B. 25%
✓ C. 40%
D. 55%

**Answer: C — ~40%**
This was the highest CALD drowning proportion ever recorded in Victoria. People from CALD backgrounds who didn't learn to swim as children face significantly higher risk, particularly during fishing and recreational activities near water.

## 2 Beach Flags, Signals & Rip Current Survival

Q7-Q13 · 7 questions

Q7 Easy Multiple choice

**What do red and yellow flags on an Australian beach mean?**

A. Dangerous — do not enter

✓ B. Patrolled — always swim here

C. Watercraft zone only

D. Marine life warning

**Answer: B — Patrolled, always swim here**
Red and yellow flags mark the patrolled swimming zone supervised by lifeguards. This is the single most important flag for swimmers to know.

Q8 Easy `Multiple choice`

**What do black and white quartered flags indicate?**

A. Swim here — it is safe

B. Dangerous conditions today

✓ C. Surfers and watercraft only — no swimmers

D. Offshore winds — no inflatables

**Answer: C — Surfers and watercraft only**
Swimmers must stay out of the black and white zone. It is designated for surfboards, bodyboards, and other watercraft.

Q9 Medium `Image-based ★`

**🖼 *[Display image of orange windsock flag]* — What does this flag mean and what should you NOT do when it is flying?**

A. Marine life present — don't swim

B. Dangerous surf — experienced swimmers only

C. No surfboards in this zone

✓ D. Offshore winds — do not use inflatables

**Answer: D — Offshore winds, no inflatables**
The orange windsock signals offshore winds. Any inflatable (lilo, ring, inflatable toy) will be carried out to sea. Many rescues involve people on inflatables who cannot swim back against an offshore wind. Use Poster 2 image for this question in Kahoot.

Q10 Medium `Multiple choice`

**If you are caught in a rip current, what is the FIRST thing you should do?**

A. Sprint directly back to shore as fast as possible

B. Dive underwater to escape the current

✓ C. Stay calm, float, and conserve your energy

D. Yell as loud as possible and thrash your arms

**Answer: C — Stay calm and float**
Panic causes swimmers to exhaust themselves fighting a current that may be moving at up to 2.5 m/s. Floating conserves energy until you can swim parallel to shore to escape.

Q11 Medium `Multiple choice`

**To escape a rip current, you should swim in which direction?**

A. Directly back toward the beach

B. Directly out to sea until the current stops

✓ C. Parallel to the shore, then angle back to the beach

D. Diagonally downward and then surface

**Answer: C — Parallel to shore, then angle back**
Rip currents are narrow channels. Swimming parallel to the shore gets you out of the channel's flow; you can then angle back in toward the beach where the waves are breaking.

Q12 Hard `True / False`

**Rip currents are easy to spot because they appear as rough, churning white water between two calmer areas.**

True

False

**Answer: False**
Rip currents actually appear as CALMER, darker water between areas of breaking waves. The waves break on shallow sandbars on either side of the rip; the deeper rip channel has less wave action, making it look deceptively safe.

Q13 Hard `Multiple choice`

**What app can you use to find the nearest patrolled beach and check patrol times in Victoria?**

A. WaterSafe

B. SafeSwim

**✓ C. BeachSafe**

D. SwimPatrol

**Answer: C — BeachSafe**
BeachSafe (beachsafe.org.au) is the free Surf Life Saving Australia app showing patrolled beaches, patrol times, current conditions, and safety alerts across Victoria.

## 3 Emergency Response — DRS ABCD & Rescue Skills

Q14–Q19 · 6 questions

Q14 Easy `Multiple choice`

**In DRS ABCD, what does the 'S' stand for?**

A. Safety

B. Stabilise

**✓ C. Send for help (call 000)**

D. Shout loudly

**Answer: C — Send for help (call 000)**
Calling 000 must happen as early as possible — ideally as soon as you confirm there is no response. The sooner emergency services are dispatched, the better the outcome.

Q15 Easy `Multiple choice`

**What is the correct CPR ratio for an adult?**

A. 15 compressions : 2 breaths

**✓ B. 30 compressions : 2 breaths**

C. 20 compressions : 1 breath

D. 10 compressions : 3 breaths

**Answer: B — 30 compressions : 2 breaths**
Compressions should be hard and fast at approximately 100–120 beats per minute, depressing the chest 5–6cm. Continue cycles until help arrives or the person recovers.

Q16 Easy `True / False`

**"Throw, don't go" means you should always try to swim to someone who is drowning before attempting a throw rescue.**

True

False

**Answer: False**
"Throw, don't go" means the OPPOSITE — always attempt a reach or throw rescue FIRST, before entering the water. Most untrained bystanders who jump in to help drown themselves, creating a second casualty.

Q17 Medium `Multiple choice`

According to the RLSSA throw rescue hierarchy, which option should you try LAST?

A. Throw a rope or buoyant object

B. Shout instructions from safety

C. Use a boat or vessel

✓ D. Enter the water to swim to them

**Answer: D — Enter the water**
The RLSSA hierarchy is: Talk → Reach → Throw → Row → Go (enter water). Entering the water should only happen if you are trained, never alone, and always with a flotation device.

Q18 Medium Image-based ★

🖼 *[Display image of an AED/defibrillator]* — What is this device and when should it be used?

A. A portable oxygen tank — use if someone can't breathe

B. A blood pressure monitor — use to check vital signs

✓ C. An AED defibrillator — use after CPR if the person hasn't recovered

D. A first aid kit scanner — use to assess injuries

**Answer: C — AED defibrillator**
AEDs are designed to be used by anyone — they give voice instructions. They will only deliver a shock if the heart needs it. Always ensure the casualty is out of the water before using. Know where your school's AED is located.

Q19 Hard Multiple choice

You find someone face-down and unresponsive at the edge of a pool. What is the VERY FIRST thing you do?

A. Immediately begin CPR

B. Roll them onto their back and open their airway

C. Call 000 immediately

✓ D. Check for danger to yourself and others

**Answer: D — Check for danger first**
The very first step of DRS ABCD is Danger. Rushing in without checking for hazards (electrical equipment near water, slippery surfaces, unstable pool edge) can injure you. Then check Response, then Send for help.

## 4 Safe Decisions, SwimSafe Rules & Inland Waterways

Q20–Q26 · 7 questions

Q20 Easy Multiple choice

Which of these is NOT one of the five LSV SwimSafe rules?

A. Read signs

B. Swim with a friend

✓ C. Only swim in daylight hours

D. Signal for help

**Answer: C — "Only swim in daylight hours" is NOT a SwimSafe rule**
The five LSV SwimSafe rules are: Read Signs, Enter Feet First, Stay In Depth, Swim With a Friend, Signal For Help. Source: lsv.com.au

Q21 Easy True / False

Victorian alpine lakes like Lake Eildon stay warm enough for safe swimming throughout summer because they are in warm climates.

True

False

**Answer: False**
Alpine lakes in Victoria are fed by snowmelt and can stay below 15°C even in December and January. This is cold enough to trigger cold

water shock — the involuntary gasp reflex — even on a hot day.

Q22 Medium Multiple choice

**Cold water shock is dangerous because it triggers which involuntary response?**

A. You fall asleep immediately

**✓ B. You gasp and inhale water involuntarily**

C. Your arms and legs become rigid and locked

D. Your vision becomes blurred underwater

**Answer: B — Involuntary gasp and inhale**
Cold water shock causes an uncontrollable gasp reflex, followed by hyperventilation and rapid heart rate. If your mouth is at water level when you gasp, you can inhale water and drown within seconds, even in shallow water.

Q23 Medium Multiple choice

**How many ways does alcohol specifically increase drowning risk? Which of these is NOT one of them?**

A. Impairs judgment and overestimates ability

B. Slows reaction time

**✓ C. Makes you a stronger swimmer temporarily**

D. Reduces ability to regulate body temperature

**Answer: C — Alcohol does NOT make you a stronger swimmer**
Alcohol impairs judgment, coordination, reaction time, and thermoregulation. It creates false confidence — the exact opposite of what C suggests.

Q24 Medium True / False

**Rivers in Victoria are generally safer for swimming than beaches because there are no waves or rip currents.**

True

**False**

**Answer: False**
Rivers and inland waterways cause the MAJORITY of Victorian drowning deaths. They have hidden currents, cold water shock risk, submerged hazards (logs, rocks, debris), no lifeguard supervision, and conditions that change dramatically after rain.

Q25 Hard Multiple choice

**According to the "1-10-1" cold water survival rule, after entering cold water you have approximately how long of useful swimming ability before muscle coordination fails?**

A. 1 minute

**✓ B. 10 minutes**

C. 30 minutes

D. 1 hour

**Answer: B — 10 minutes**
The 1-10-1 rule: 1 minute to control breathing after cold water immersion; 10 minutes of useful swimming ability before muscles lose coordination; up to 1 hour before hypothermia in most adults.

Q26 Hard Image-based ★

**🖼 *[Display image of a river after heavy rain — brown, fast-moving water]* — Which of the following is the BEST decision?**

A. It looks fast but it's still safe to swim — just stay near the edge

B. Swimming is safer than usual because the water is deeper

**✓ C. Do not enter — wait 48–72 hours for water levels to drop and debris to clear**

D. It's only dangerous for weak swimmers — strong swimmers are fine

**Answer: C — Do not enter, wait 48-72 hours**
After heavy rain, rivers carry submerged debris (logs, fences, rocks), move faster, and are murkier. Even experienced swimmers have drowned in post-rain conditions. The safest decision is always to wait. Source: paddle.org.au, park.vic.gov.au

## 5 Personal Action Plan & Community Responsibility

Q27-Q30 · 4 questions

Q27 Easy True / False

**Drowning is a noisy emergency — a drowning person will always be screaming and waving their arms visibly.**

- True
- **False**

**Answer: False**
Drowning is almost always SILENT. A drowning person cannot call for help because they cannot breathe. They may slip under quietly with little or no splash. This is why constant supervision and the buddy system are critical.

Q28 Medium Multiple choice

**What is the universal signal for a swimmer in distress?**

- A. Wave both arms above your head and shout
- **✓ B. Raise ONE arm above your head**
- C. Float face-down
- D. Splash repeatedly

**Answer: B — Raise ONE arm**
Raising one arm is the internationally recognised signal for a swimmer needing help. It conserves energy compared to waving both arms, and is clearly visible to lifeguards scanning the water.

Q29 Medium Multiple choice

**What is the most important single action an individual can take to reduce their risk of drowning in Victoria?**

- A. Always swim with goggles so you can see underwater
- B. Only swim in the morning when water is calmer
- **✓ C. Always swim at patrolled locations between the flags**
- D. Avoid swimming in summer when drownings peak

**Answer: C — Always swim at patrolled locations**
The evidence is unambiguous: zero Victorian drowning deaths occurred at patrolled locations in 2023–24. Swimming between the flags with lifeguard supervision is the single most protective action anyone can take.

Q30 Hard Multiple choice

**Which organisation publishes the annual Victorian Drowning Report that is used as evidence in this unit?**

- A. Victoria Police
- B. Parks Victoria
- **✓ C. Life Saving Victoria (LSV)**
- D. Surf Life Saving Australia

**Answer: C — Life Saving Victoria (LSV)**
LSV publishes the Victorian Drowning Report annually using State Coroner data. It is the primary source for water safety statistics in Victorian schools. Access it at: lsv.com.au/research/victorian-drowning-reports/

## Diving, Spinal Injuries & High-Risk Teenage Behaviour

Q31–Q38 · 8 questions

Q31 Easy Multiple choice

**Unsafe diving accounts for approximately what percentage of all spinal cord injuries in Australia?**

A. 2%

B. 5%

✓ **C. 10%**

D. 25%

**Answer: C — 10%**
Unsafe diving also accounts for approximately 20% of all quadriplegia cases in Australia. Source: AIHW Diving Injury Report — aihw.gov.au

Q32 Easy Multiple choice

**What percentage of Australian aquatic spinal injury patients are male?**

A. 65%

B. 75%

C. 85%

✓ **D. 95%**

**Answer: D — 95%**
This is not a coincidence — it reflects masculinity norms, peer pressure, and risk-taking behaviour patterns that are structurally driven. Source: Royal Perth Hospital spinal injury review.

Q33 Easy Multiple choice

**Which age group has the HIGHEST incidence of diving-related spinal injuries in Australia?**

✓ **A. 10–14 years**

B. 15–19 years

C. 20–24 years

D. 25–29 years

**Answer: A — 10–14 years**
This makes school-based water safety education critical at exactly the Year 7–8 level. Source: AIHW Diving Injury Report.

Q34 Medium Multiple choice

**A teenage boy dives from a jetty at a location he has used safely before. He sustains a serious spinal injury. A sandbank had formed beneath the jumping spot since his last visit. This case study best illustrates which concept?**

A. Cold water shock

✓ **B. False confidence from prior experience**

C. Bystander effect

D. Peer pressure

**Answer: B — False confidence from prior experience**
This describes the Bawley Beach jetty incident (NSW 2024). Prior safety at a location does not guarantee current safety — water depth changes constantly due to tidal action, sediment, and seasonal variation.

Q35 Medium Multiple choice

**Which of the following BEST explains why cervical spine injuries from diving often result in permanent quadriplegia rather than temporary paralysis?**

A. The force of impact is always fatal

B. Cold water worsens spinal injuries

✓ **C. The spinal cord tissue cannot regenerate after being severed or severely compressed**

D. Quadriplegia is only caused by diving — not other injuries

**Answer: C**
Unlike many body tissues, spinal cord nerve tissue (neurons) cannot regenerate after being severed or severely compressed. Approximately two-thirds of Australian aquatic spinal injury patients suffer permanent disability.

Q36 **Medium** `True / False`

**True or False: "If the water is clear, it is safe to dive because you can see the bottom is deep enough."**

A. True — clear water means deep water

✓ **B. False — water clarity is unrelated to depth**

**Answer: B — False**
Water clarity tells you nothing about depth. Dangerously shallow water can be crystal clear. The only safe approach is to enter feet-first and physically check depth before diving.

Q37 **Hard** `Short answer`

**Royal Life Saving Australia states that more people drown in inland waterways than any other location in Australia. Identify THREE specific factors that make inland waterways more dangerous than patrolled beaches, and for each factor explain the specific mechanism that increases risk.**

**Model answer:**
Any three of: (1) **Depth changes constantly** — drought, flooding, sediment and dam releases alter depth unpredictably, creating hidden shallow zones; (2) **Poor visibility** — submerged rocks, logs, debris invisible beneath turbid water; (3) **Cold water shock** — triggers gasping reflex and muscle failure even in hot weather; (4) **Remote rescue delay** — limited phone reception, no lifeguards, and difficult road access extend emergency response time, worsening neurological outcomes; (5) **Alcohol and group risk-taking** — common combination of alcohol, males, and peer pressure at river/dam locations multiplies risk.

Q38 **Hard** `Analysis`

**The data shows 95% of aquatic spinal injury patients are male. A student argues: "This is because males are naturally more reckless than females." Using the social determinants framework, explain why this is an insufficient explanation and propose a more complete structural account.**

**Model answer:**
"Naturally more reckless" implies an innate biological difference, but the social determinants framework shows risk-taking is largely socially constructed. Masculinity norms — cultural expectations that males should accept dares, not show fear, and demonstrate courage through physical risk — drive the behaviour. These norms are reinforced through peer groups, media, and social reward systems. A structural account would note: (1) males are socialised from childhood to suppress fear responses; (2) peer pressure operates differently for males in group settings near water; (3) the same behaviour (jumping from a bridge) is praised for males and discouraged for females. Effective prevention must address the social norms, not just inform individuals about the risk.